6 Everyday use and help

QUICK

10. The plan: a careful order, with checkpoints

Quick version

No time to read it all? This is the short version. The full guide is below.

- A careful order for the guides, with a checkpoint after each step. A "session" is about 2 to 3 hours.
- Build the foundation first and prove each layer works. Never add a new thing on top of something that is not working.
- Before you begin (15 minutes): read guide 00, start a notes file `lab-notes.txt`, and have a password manager ready.
- The order: Ubuntu, then Docker and your garden, Uptime Kuma and backups, Gemini, Home Assistant, n8n email, sensors and watering, your readings on the website, and last the internet.
- The internet steps (sessions 14 to 16): practise with a test name first (guide 04, Part C), then do it for real with guide 23, Parts 9 to 11.
- Watering: the valve must work dry on the table before it ever touches water. Never skip the dry test.
- Every week (15 minutes): `bash lab/09-health-check.sh`, Ubuntu updates, and a copy of `backups/` on a USB stick.